IPL Auction Value Intelligence

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Which IPL auction buys earned their price?

Every auction buy from 2013 to 2026, scored on runs, wickets and fielding per crore, then rolled up to franchises, roles and price brackets.

BDM project · franchise analytics brief for the next auction · prepared by Nabaskar

₹3,269.2 Cr	1,380	₹2.37 Cr	2.0x	99.0%
Auction spend 2013–2026	Auction buys	Average price per buy	Price inflation, 2025 vs 2013	Spend matched to ball-by-ball data

Questions answered

- ✓ Most impact per crore
- ✓ Best bargains & worst buys
- ✓ Does efficiency win matches?
- ✓ Roles & overseas premium
- ✓ Price inflation since 2013
- ✓ Base-price vs marquee buys

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Auction Market
How far have prices inflated since 2013?

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Franchise Efficiency
Who gets the most impact per crore, and does it win?

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Player Value Map
Price vs impact for every buy: Stars, Steals, Overpaid

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Steals and Overpaid
Best bargains, worst buys, Bargain XI and Overpaid XI

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Role and Nationality
Are all-rounders and overseas stars worth the premium?

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Do base-price buys beat marquee signings per crore?

Tip Ctrl+click a card or pill in Desktop. On pages 3 and 4, right-click any player → Drill through → Player Profile.

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Average auction price has doubled since 2013: ₹1.7 Cr per buy then, ₹3.5 Cr at the 2025 mega auction

Q5 · How much have auction prices inflated since 2013, and does a high price predict high output?

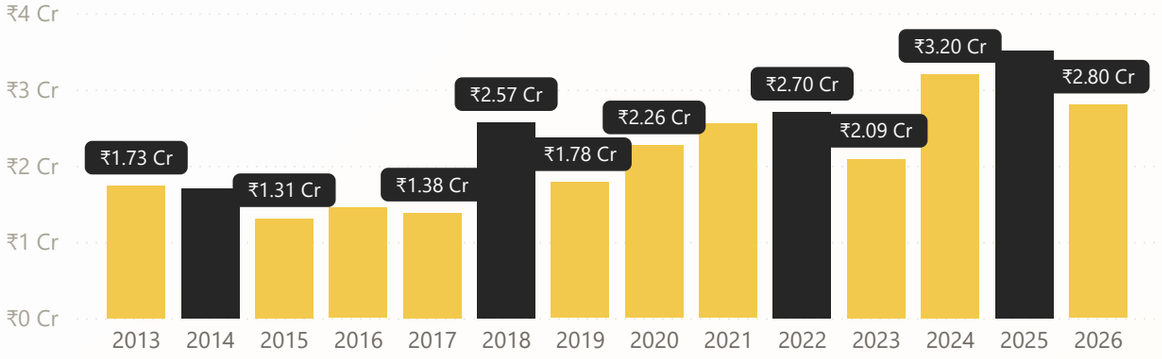
₹3,269.2 Cr	₹2.37 Cr	2.0x	1.6x	₹27.0 Cr	245%
Auction spend 2013–2026	Average price per buy	2025 mega auction vs 2013	2026 auction vs 2013	Highest price ever paid	Paid above base (2025–26)

Reading the page

Charcoal bars mark mega-auction seasons (2014, 2018, 2022, 2025), when every squad is rebuilt and prices jump.

2013 prices were in US$ and are converted at ₹54/$. Base prices exist only for the 2025 and 2026 auctions.

Average auction price per buy (₹ Cr) · charcoal = mega auction



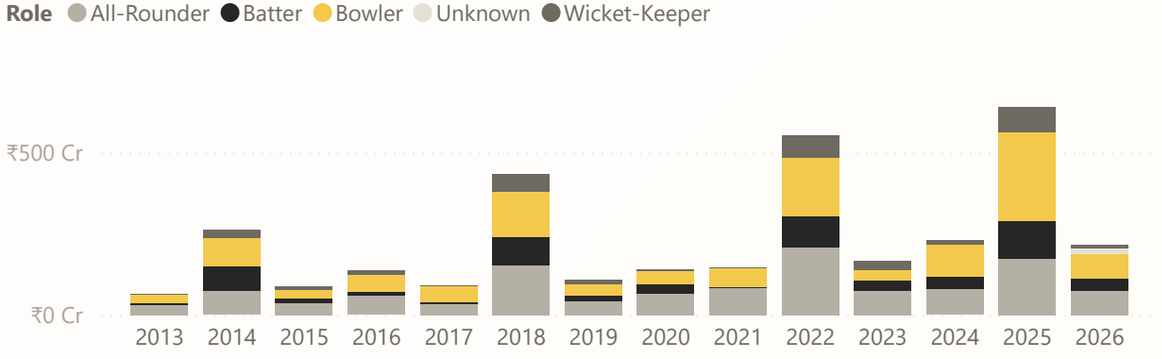
Most expensive buy each season

Season	Most expensive buy	Price
2026	Cameron Green (KKR)	₹25.2 Cr
2025	Rishabh Pant (LSG)	₹27.0 Cr
2024	Mitchell Starc (KKR)	₹24.8 Cr
2023	Sam Curran (PBKS)	₹18.5 Cr
2022	Ishan Kishan (MI)	₹15.3 Cr
2021	Christopher Morris (RR)	₹16.3 Cr
2020	Pat Cummins (KKR)	₹15.5 Cr
2019	Jaydev Unadkat (RR)	₹8.4 Cr
2018	Ben Stokes (RR)	₹12.5 Cr
2017	Ben Stokes (RPS)	₹14.5 Cr
2016	Shane Watson (RCB)	₹9.5 Cr
2015	Yuvraj Singh (DC)	₹16.0 Cr
2014	Yuvraj Singh (RCB)	₹14.0 Cr
2013	Glenn Maxwell (MI)	₹5.4 Cr

So what

Budget about 2× the 2013 price for the same buy at a mega auction (1.6× at the 2026 mini auction); 2025–26 bids averaged 245% above base price.

Total auction spend by season and role (₹ Cr)



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2026: RR got 1.63× fair value from ₹34 Cr of buys; PBKS spent the most (₹108 Cr) for 0.72×

Q1 · Which franchise gets the most impact per crore? Q3 · Do franchises that spend efficiently win more?

₹661.5 Cr	40K	1.66	RR · 1.63	PBKS · 0.72
Auction spend in squads	Impact Points from priced buys	₹ lakh per Impact Point	Best Value Index	Worst Value Index

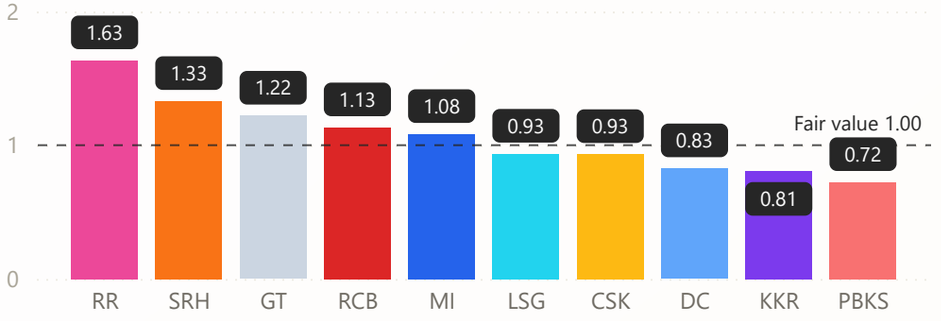
Season

2026

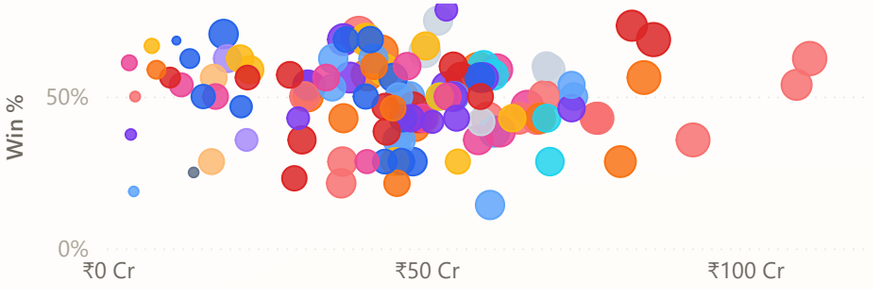
Franchise

All

Value Index by franchise · 1.00 = fair value



Does money buy wins? One dot per team-season, all seasons



₹ lakh paid per Impact Point · green = cheaper than that season's league rate, red = dearer

ShortCode	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026
CSK	0.77	0.58	0.58			0.83	0.87	1.15	0.76	1.20	1.32	1.49	1.87	1.78
DC	1.23	1.44	1.27	1.26	1.00	1.20	0.85	1.03	1.01	1.11	1.19	1.27	2.09	2.01
GL				0.50	0.51									
GT										1.26	1.01	1.60	1.73	1.36
KKR	0.85	0.74	0.72	0.67	0.81	1.38	1.73	1.29	1.06	1.33	1.28	2.29	2.11	2.05
LSG										1.23	1.31	1.45	1.84	1.77
MI	5.29	0.93	0.76	0.55	0.43	1.29	1.25	1.22	1.37	1.22	1.37	1.38	1.14	1.53
PBKS	1.20	0.62	0.87	0.87	0.72	1.30	1.49	1.15	1.28	1.37	1.57	1.59	1.86	2.29
PWI	3.89													
RCB	0.52	0.80	0.84	0.78	0.98	1.21	1.24	1.15	1.41	1.22	1.86	1.29	1.72	1.46
RPS				0.93	0.50									
RR	0.34	0.55	0.44			1.24	1.31	1.26	1.37	1.21	1.54	1.31	1.53	1.01
SRH	0.51	0.90	0.69	0.75	0.79	0.95	1.17	1.08	1.39	1.50	1.61	1.47	1.46	1.25

So what

Over 2013–2026, CSK (1.19) and RR (1.14) run the most efficient auctions. Spend is unrelated to win % (r = −0.03); Value Index is not (r = +0.35). Buy output per crore, not names.

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2026: 24 steals delivered above-median impact at below-median prices; 8 buys were overpaid

Q2 · Price vs Impact Points for every auction buy in the season. Hover for the player card; right-click → Drill through → Player Profile.

171	24	8	₹1.80 Cr	152	Kartik Tyagi · 33.9×
Auction-priced players	Steals	Overpaid	Median price	Median Impact Points	Best Value Index

Season
2026

Franchise
All

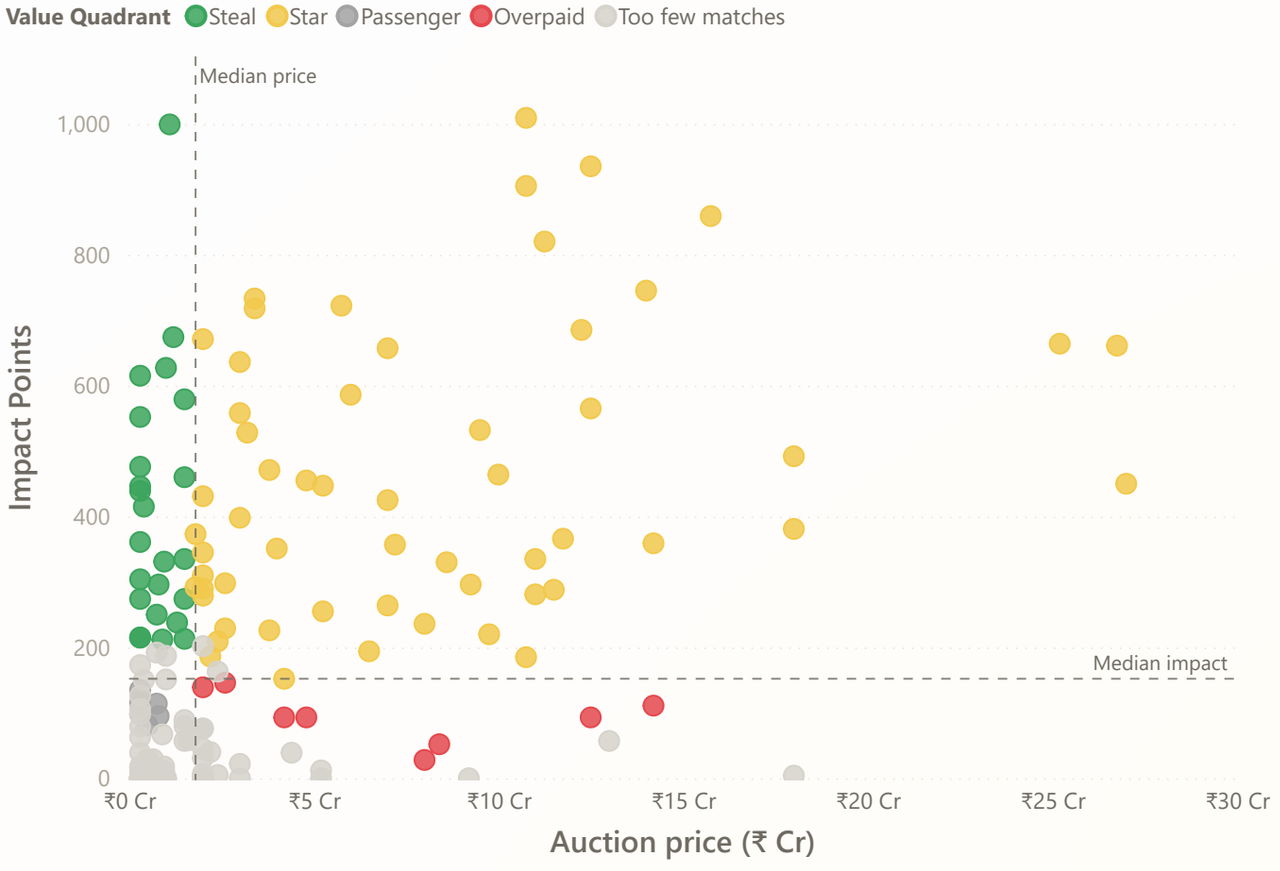
Role
All

Nationality
All

- **So what**

Keep the Steals and Stars; Overpaid and Passenger buys are the release shortlist before the next auction.

Price vs Impact Points · dashed lines = season medians



Quadrant mix

Quadrant	Players	Spend
Steal	24	₹18.9 Cr
Star	57	₹462.0 Cr
Passenger	6	₹3.0 Cr
Overpaid	8	₹56.7 Cr
Too few matches	76	₹121.0 Cr

Best Value Index this season

Player	Price	VI
Kartik Tyagi	₹0.3 Cr	33.95
Prince Yadav	₹0.3 Cr	30.47
Sakib Hussain	₹0.3 Cr	26.27
Brijesh Sharma	₹0.3 Cr	24.62
Praful Hinge	₹0.3 Cr	24.23
Shivang Kumar	₹0.3 Cr	19.93
Anukul Roy	₹0.4 Cr	17.18
Mukesh Choudhary	₹0.3 Cr	16.78

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2026: ₹0.3 Cr Kartik Tyagi returned 34× fair value while ₹27 Cr Rishabh Pant was overpaid by ₹19.5 Cr

Q2 · Best bargains and worst buys of the season (min 5 matches). Right-click a name → Drill through → Player Profile.

Season

2026

Unsold in 2026	IPL pts
Karn Sharma	3,209
Deepak Hooda	2,570
Jonny Bairstow	2,293
Vijay Shankar	2,034
Manan Vohra	1,383
Devon Conway	1,350
Murugan Ashwin	1,276

Top 10 steals · highest Value Index

Player	Team	Price	Impact	₹L/pt	Value Index
Kartik Tyagi	KKR	₹0.3 Cr	615	0.05	33.95
Prince Yadav	LSG	₹0.3 Cr	552	0.05	30.47
Sakib Hussain	SRH	₹0.3 Cr	476	0.06	26.27
Brijesh Sharma	RR	₹0.3 Cr	446	0.07	24.62
Praful Hinge	SRH	₹0.3 Cr	439	0.07	24.23
Shivang Kumar	SRH	₹0.3 Cr	361	0.08	19.93
Anukul Roy	KKR	₹0.4 Cr	415	0.10	17.18
Mukesh Choudhary	CSK	₹0.3 Cr	304	0.10	16.78
Yash Raj Punja	RR	₹0.3 Cr	274	0.11	15.12
Vaibhav Suryavanshi	RR	₹1.1 Cr	999	0.11	15.04

Top 10 overpaid · price above output value

Player	Team	Price	Impact	₹L/pt	Overpaid by
Rishabh Pant	LSG	₹27.0 Cr	450	6.00	₹19.5 Cr
Shreyas Iyer	PBKS	₹26.8 Cr	661	4.05	₹15.8 Cr
Cameron Green	KKR	₹25.2 Cr	664	3.80	₹14.2 Cr
Prashant Veer	CSK	₹14.2 Cr	111	12.79	₹12.4 Cr
Yuzvendra Chahal	PBKS	₹18.0 Cr	381	4.72	₹11.7 Cr
Trent Boult	MI	₹12.5 Cr	93	13.44	₹11.0 Cr
Arshdeep Singh	PBKS	₹18.0 Cr	492	3.66	₹9.9 Cr
Kartik Sharma	CSK	₹14.2 Cr	359	3.96	₹8.3 Cr
T. Natarajan	DC	₹10.8 Cr	185	5.81	₹7.7 Cr
Auqib Dar	DC	₹8.4 Cr	52	16.15	₹7.5 Cr

Bargain XI · 4 batters, 1 keeper, 2 all-rounders, 4 bowlers

Role	Player	Price	VI
All-Rounder	Anukul Roy	₹0.4 Cr	17.18
All-Rounder	Suryansh Shedge	₹0.3 Cr	11.87
Batter	Aniket Verma	₹0.3 Cr	7.45
Batter	Devdutt Padikkal	₹2.0 Cr	5.56
Batter	Himmat Singh	₹0.3 Cr	6.35
Batter	Vaibhav Suryavanshi	₹1.1 Cr	15.04
Bowler	Brijesh Sharma	₹0.3 Cr	24.62
Bowler	Kartik Tyagi	₹0.3 Cr	33.95
Bowler	Prince Yadav	₹0.3 Cr	30.47
Bowler	Sakib Hussain	₹0.3 Cr	26.27
Wicket-Keeper	Ryan Rickelton	₹1.0 Cr	10.38

Overpaid XI · biggest gap between price and output

Role	Player	Price	Overpaid by
All-Rounder	Cameron Green	₹25.2 Cr	₹14.2 Cr
All-Rounder	Prashant Veer	₹14.2 Cr	₹12.4 Cr
Batter	Kartik Sharma	₹14.2 Cr	₹8.3 Cr
Batter	Nehal Wadhera	₹4.2 Cr	₹2.7 Cr
Batter	Rishabh Pant	₹27.0 Cr	₹19.5 Cr
Batter	Shreyas Iyer	₹26.8 Cr	₹15.8 Cr
Bowler	Arshdeep Singh	₹18.0 Cr	₹9.9 Cr
Bowler	T. Natarajan	₹10.8 Cr	₹7.7 Cr
Bowler	Trent Boult	₹12.5 Cr	₹11.0 Cr
Bowler	Yuzvendra Chahal	₹18.0 Cr	₹11.7 Cr
Wicket-Keeper	Phil Salt	₹11.5 Cr	₹6.7 Cr

So what

Every one of the five most overpaid 2026 players cost ₹14 Cr or more; the best value sat in ₹30-lakh buys. Open the demo here.

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2026: overseas buys cost 2.4× as much as Indian buys but returned less per crore (0.88 vs 1.11)

Q4 · Are batters, bowlers, all-rounders or keepers over- or under-priced? Do overseas players earn their premium?

142%	0.88	1.11	All-Rounder · 1.13	77
Overseas price premium	Overseas Value Index	Indian Value Index	Best-value role	Auction buys

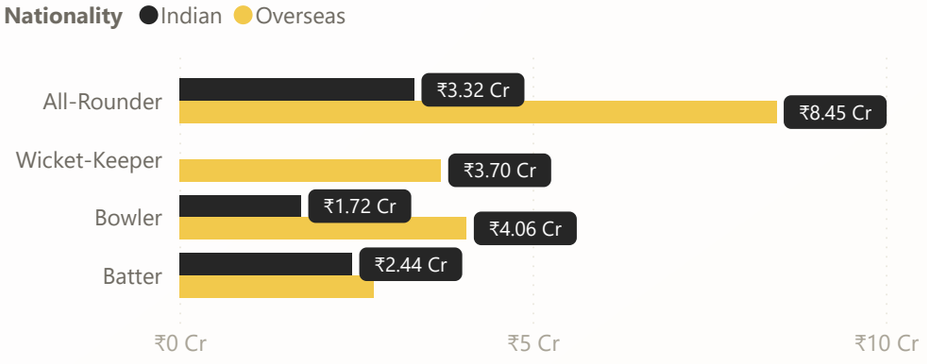
Season

2026

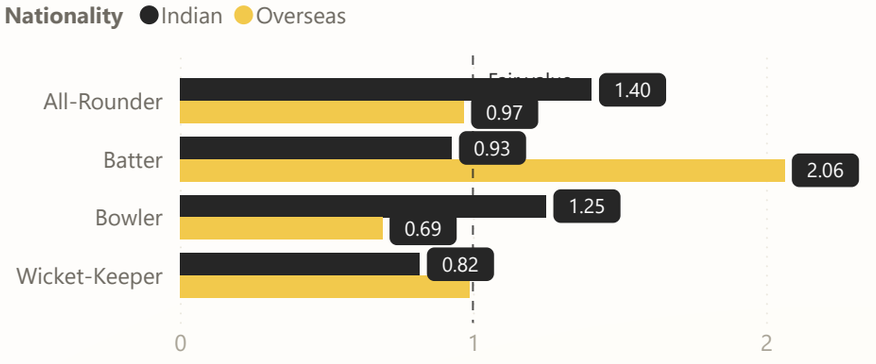
So what

Across 2013–2026 Indian bowlers are the best-value role (1.22) and overseas bowlers the worst (0.84): spend overseas slots only on proven match-winners.

Average auction price by role (₹ Cr)



Value Index by role · 1.00 = fair value



₹ lakh per Impact Point by role and nationality · green = cheaper than league rate

Nationality	Indian			Overseas		
Role	Lakh per Point	Spend Cr	Player Seasons	Lakh per Point	Spend Cr	Player Seasons
All-Rounder	1.18	₹64.7 Cr	42	1.71	₹110.1 Cr	20
Batter	1.79	₹95.1 Cr	29	0.80	₹16.5 Cr	11
Bowler	1.33	₹139.2 Cr	50	2.40	₹141.8 Cr	28
Wicket-Keeper	2.03	₹38.5 Cr	11	1.68	₹39.4 Cr	10

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2026: buys under ₹2 Cr returned 2.7–3.5× fair value per crore; ₹10 Cr+ signings returned 0.55×

Q6 · How often do base-price and cheap buys outperform expensive marquee signings, per crore?

2.71	0.55	32%	83%	50
Base-price buys · Value Index	₹10 Cr+ buys · Value Index	Base-price buys beating median impact	₹10 Cr+ buys beating median impact	Base-price buys

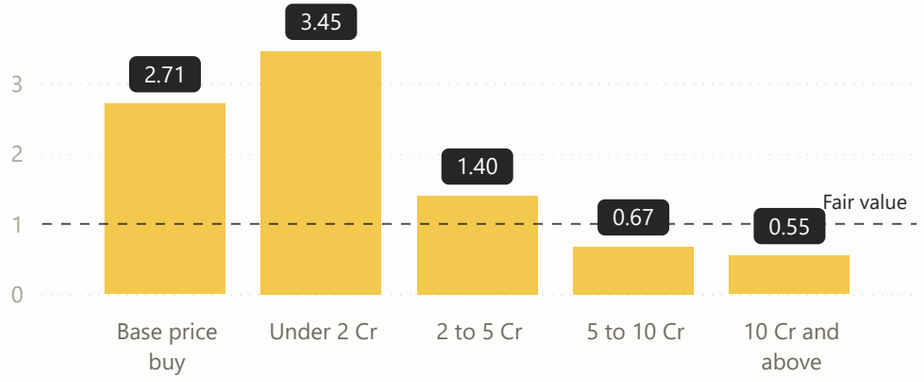
Season

2026

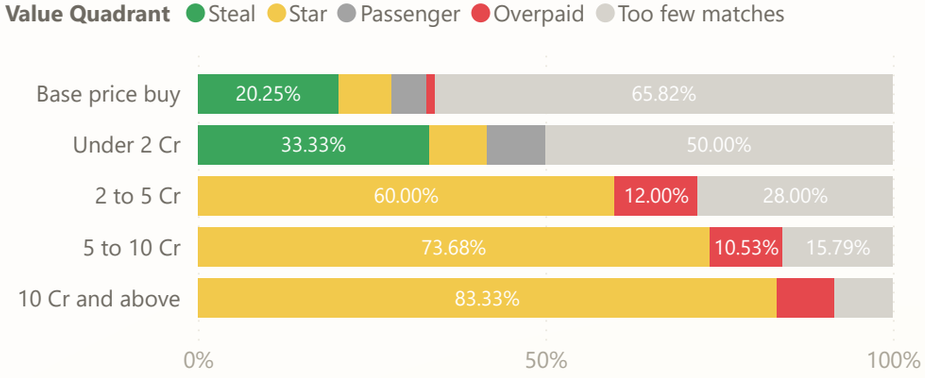
So what

It holds across 2013–2026 (base-price 4.1× vs ₹10 Cr+ 0.49×). Marquee buys beat median impact 88% of the time, but each crore buys far more output in the cheap brackets.

Value Index by price bracket · 1.00 = fair value



Value quadrant mix within each bracket (% of player-seasons)



Bracket scorecard

Price bracket	Player-seasons	Spend	Impact Points	Impact / match	₹ lakh per point	Beat median impact	Value Index
Base price buy	79	₹67.1 Cr	10,977	33.4	0.61	32%	2.71
Under 2 Cr	24	₹23.3 Cr	4,860	33.5	0.48	46%	3.45
2 to 5 Cr	25	₹80.4 Cr	6,780	33.1	1.19	64%	1.40
5 to 10 Cr	19	₹138.1 Cr	5,613	37.7	2.46	74%	0.67
10 Cr and above	24	₹352.6 Cr	11,714	41.1	3.01	83%	0.55

Methodology: one score for bat, ball and field, judged against each season's market

Sources, the Impact Points weights, the contract rule, the analysis window and the limits of this analysis

14	921	1,380	778	99.0%
Seasons analysed	Matches parsed	Auction buys	Players in the model	Spend matched to Cricsheet

Data sources

Auction prices 2013–2026 · Kaggle IPL Auction Dataset (sunnyyadav754), one CSV per auction.
kaggle.com/datasets/sunnyyadav754/ipl-auction-dataset-20132026

Ball-by-ball, playing XIs, results · Cricsheet IPL JSON, 1,243 matches (updated Oct 2026). Used instead of the Kaggle ball-by-ball CSV because that file has no fielder column.
cricsheet.org/downloads

Name matching · Cricsheet Register (people.csv, names.csv).
cricsheet.org/register

Role and Indian/Overseas fill-in · Kaggle IPL Player Auction Dataset 2013–2022 (kalilurrahman) and the official TATA IPL 2025 auction list.

2026 unsold players · Wisden IPL 2026 unsold list.

Hand-made · team_map.csv (franchise renames) and name_fixes.csv (manual name matches).

Analysis window

Seasons 2013–2026 (14 seasons, 921 matches). 2008–2012 are out: no auction price data. Super overs excluded.

Impact Points (fantasy-style weights)

Run scored · 1 Four (bonus) · 1 Six (bonus) · 2
Wicket (credited to bowler) · 25 Dot ball · 1
Catch · 8 Stumping · 12 Run-out involvement · 6
One scale for batters, bowlers and keepers, so they sit on the same chart.

Value Index

(share of league Impact Points) ÷ (share of league auction spend), computed season by season and summed. 1.00 = fair value; above 1 = more output than the money suggests. Only auction-priced player-seasons count.

Value quadrant

Each priced player-season vs that season's median price and median Impact Points → Star, Steal, Overpaid, Passenger. Under 5 matches = Too few matches.

Overpay

Price minus fair value, where fair value = Impact Points × the league's ₹ per point that season.

Contract carry-forward rule

A price covers the auction season and later seasons until the earliest of: the player's next auction − 1, the next mega auction − 1 (2014, 2018, 2022, 2025), or 2026. Later seasons count only while the player still plays for that team.

Assumptions and limits

- Retained, traded and replacement players have no auction price: 'Unpriced', excluded from value measures.
- 2013 prices in US$, converted at ₹54/$ (parameter UsdInrRate2013).
- Base prices exist only for 2025–26; earlier, a buy at that era's minimum base (₹10/20 lakh) counts as base-price.
- 99.0% of auction spend (₹3,237 of ₹3,269 Cr) is matched to a Cricsheet player; most of the 66 unmatched buys never played an IPL match.
- Matches = playing-XI appearances (Cricsheet), incl. impact-player substitutes.
- The weights are a judgement call; the runs-only and wickets-only measures tell the same story at the top of the tables.